

State of the Web 2020– 2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

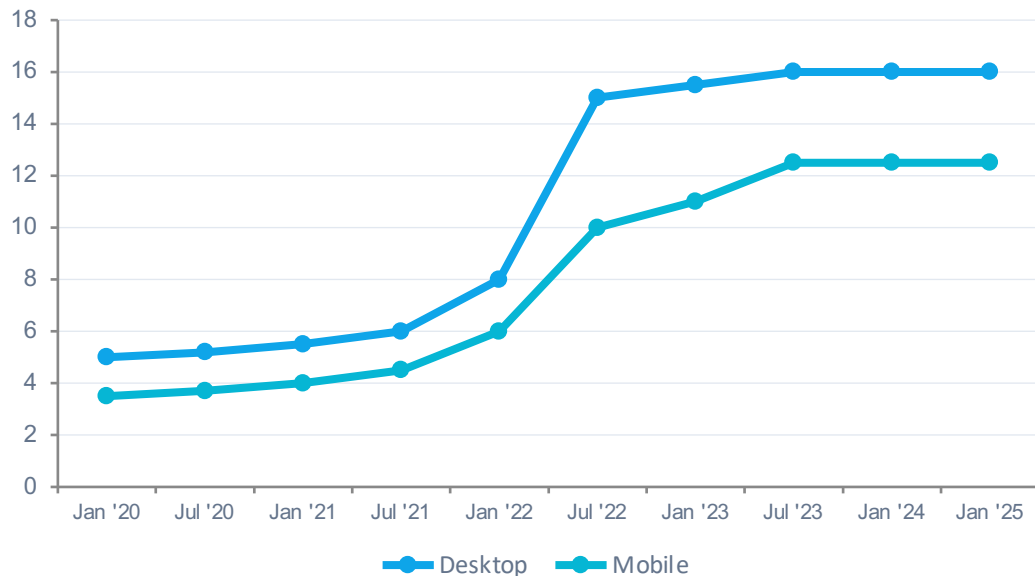
Data Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Time Range: January 2020 – March 2026

<https://httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web>

Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Sharp jump around mid-2022; plateau reached by mid-2023

16M

Desktop URLs

▲ 220% since Jan 2020

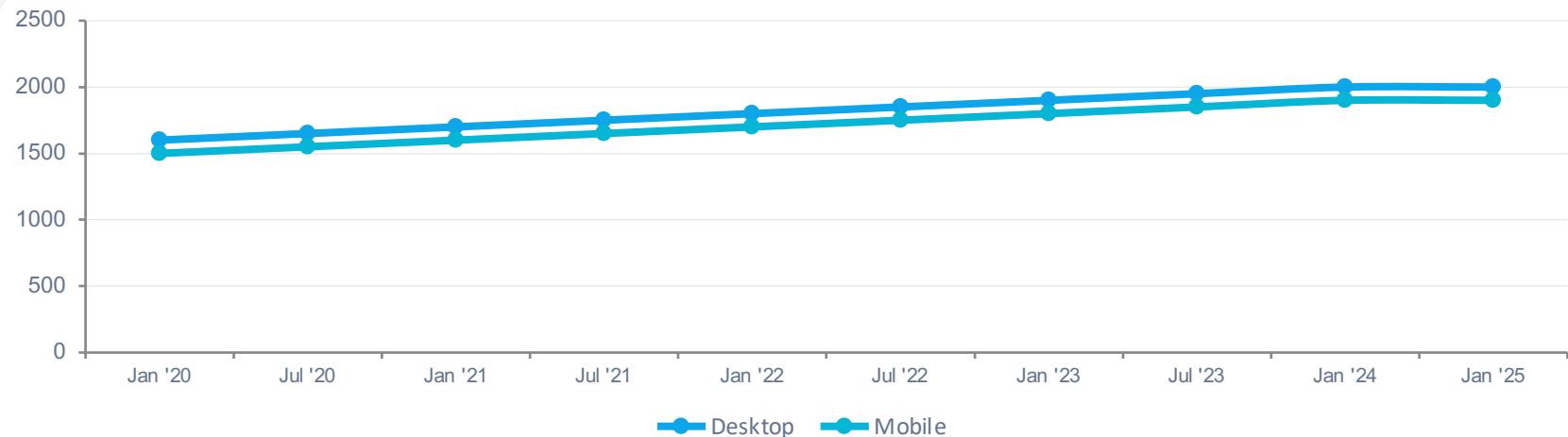
12.5M

Mobile URLs

▲ 257% since Jan 2020

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily

Desktop median now ~2,000 KB, up 25% from 2020 baseline



~2,000 KB

Desktop median ▲ 25% since 2020

~1,900 KB

Mobile median ▲ 25% | 75th pctile desktop > 4,000 KB

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More requests, fewer connections — multiplexing at work

76

Requests / Page (Desktop)

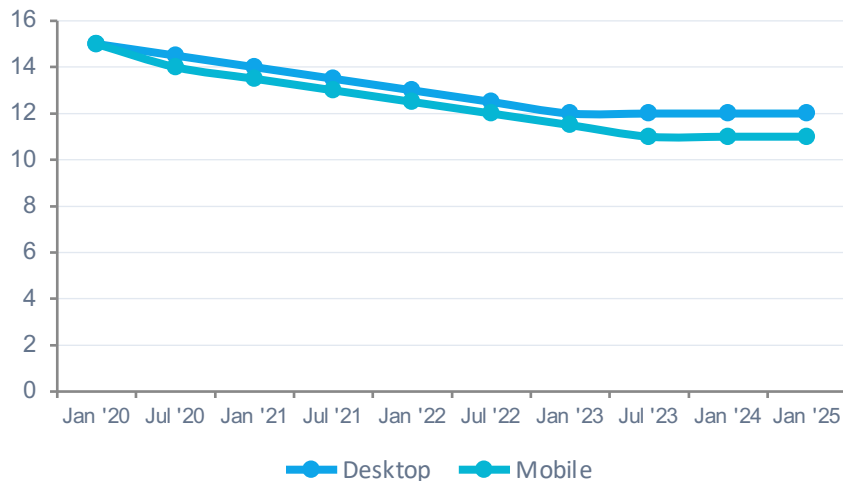
▲ 2.7% since 2020

71

Requests / Page (Mobile)

▲ 2.9% since 2020

TCP Connections per Page (Declining)



TCP connections fell 14.3% (desktop) and 26.7% (mobile) — HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing allow many requests over fewer connections

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%

Encryption Is Now the Default

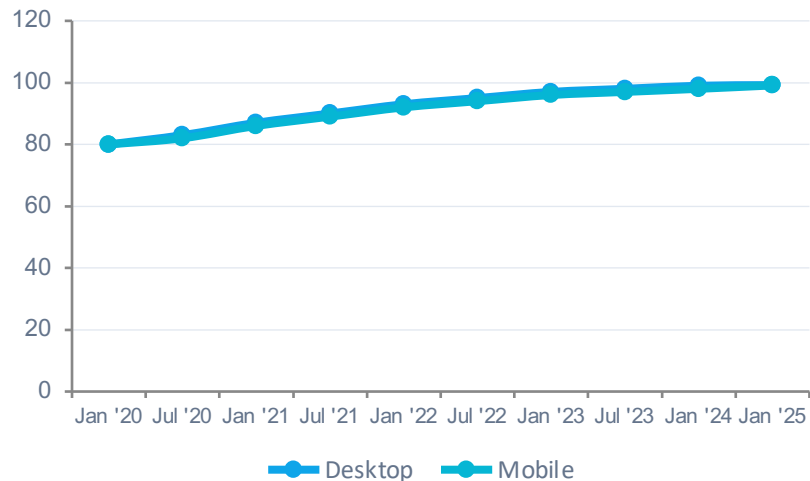
99%+

99.2% Desktop requests

99.1% Mobile requests

▲ 19–20 percentage points since 2020

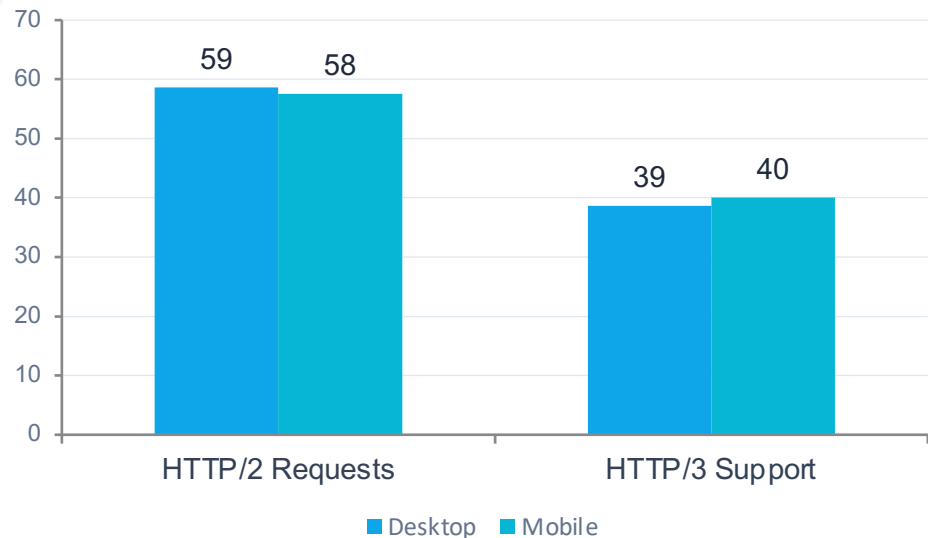
HTTPS Adoption Over Time



Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Protocol adoption snapshot — the web transitions to next-generation protocols



HTTP/2

58.6% desktop / 57.6% mobile
Growth modest (1–3%); HTTP/3 absorbs newer adoption

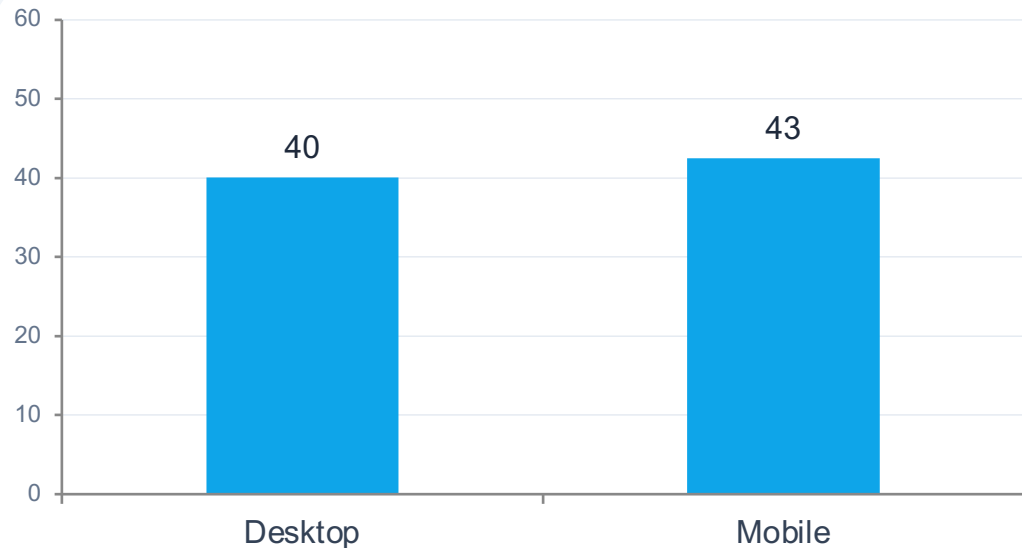
HTTP/3

38.7% desktop / 40.0% mobile
Explosive growth from near-zero — fastest-growing protocol metric

HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support, not actual usage — fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc headers

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile

Up 61% since 2020 — but more than half of pages still risk FOIT



Desktop: ▲ 14.9% since 2020 | Mobile: ▲ 61.0% since 2020

What is font-display?

The font-display CSS property controls how web fonts render during loading, helping avoid the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT). Without it, users may see blank text while fonts load.

58% of pages

still don't use font-display

Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

2

HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

3

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

4

Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%.

5

Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, significant room remains to improve FOIT avoidance during font loading.

Benchmark your own sites against these baselines — httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web
